

Healthy Village

Community action and participation is how a village takes ownership of its health. Trust and ownership are what make health work last.

For health workers

Key messages

- Use the six steps of community action: 1. Get to know the community. 2. Work out community needs. 3. Decide what to do first. 4. Plan how to do it. 5. Take action together. 6. How did we do?
- Work with the ward health committee, village leaders, churches and women's groups.
- Use the Helti Ples checklist with village leaders to see what the village has and what it needs.
- Draw a community map and update it at least every 6 months. Use it to plan where to focus.

- Plan your work for at least three months, including a mix of health promotion activities.
- Link the village to the health centre and to outreach clinics. Collect simple health data and report it every month.
- The Healthy Islands idea means making the places where people live, work, learn and play healthy places.

Helti Ples checklist

Tick one box for each: none, some or enough.

	None	Some	Enough
1. Village health committee			
2. Clean houses and good air			
3. Clean water			
4. Clean village everywhere			
5. Good health services			
6. A place of worship			
7. A good school			
8. Working together			

	None	Some	Enough
9. Small gardens near houses			
10. Good roads and transport			
11. Many ways to earn money			
12. Peace and good living together			
13. Community bank			
14. MCH clinic			
15. Change bad traditional customs			
16. Teach people about health			

Raise with the health facility if

- There is an outbreak or many people are sick at once
- The village cannot reach the health centre because of the road or river
- Supplies you rely on have run out

Run a village session

- 1.** Meet in a shaded, central place at a time when families can come. Greet everyone and say what today's topic is.
- 2.** Ask what people already know and what they have heard. Listen first.
- 3.** Share three key messages from this page in your local language. Use pictures and real examples from the village.
- 4.** Ask people to say the messages back in their own words, and answer questions.
- 5.** Agree on one action the village will take this month. Refer anyone who is unwell, and record who came.

General information only. Follow the advice of your health centre and current national guidelines. Based on the National Department of Health Village Health Assistant (VHA) training curriculum.